AI & Tech News Digest

Evening Edition -- Today's Top Stories

Thursday, November 12, 2026

1 AWS Releases AWS Emulator Built by Autonomous AI Agents

AWS has released AWS Emulator, a free, CC0-licensed local emulator covering over 200 AWS services built directly from 438 API models. Remarkably, autonomous AI agents authored 100% of the codebase required for the tool. At launch, the emulator successfully passes 56.6% of more than 42,000 published fidelity tests. This marks one of the largest production software tools generated entirely by autonomous code agents.

Why it matters:
Local cloud emulation dramatically cuts infrastructure costs and speeds up development cycles. As AI agents demonstrate full-scale codebase generation, engineers can spend less time writing boilerplate emulator code and more time on high-level system architecture.

Source: MarkTechPost | https://www.marktechpost.com/2026/11/12/aws-emulator-local-aws-api-emulator-ai-a...

2 AI Chatbots Are Recommending Risky and Fake Retail Websites

A recent study by brand protection firm Podqii revealed that leading AI chatbots, including ChatGPT, Gemini, and Perplexity, are directing online shoppers to fake and malicious retail websites. When asked for product recommendations or store links, the models occasionally hallucinate or output SEO-spammed imposter URLs. Attackers are increasingly optimizing scam pages specifically to target AI search indexers and retrieval-augmented generation systems. This poses significant security risks for unsuspecting consumers relying on AI assistants for online shopping.

Why it matters:
Enterprise engineers building consumer-facing AI agents must implement strict URL filtering and trust-score verification. Protecting RAG systems from adversarial web data is fast becoming a core cybersecurity requirement.

Source: The Verge | https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/1032020/gemini-chatgpt-perpl...

3 Claimed AI Discovery of Maya Archaeology Site Turns Out Already Mapped

Earlier this week, a researcher reported that a team of autonomous AI agents had successfully identified a previously unmapped Maya archaeological site in Mexico using spatial data. However, professional archaeologists quickly debunked the claim, demonstrating that the site had already been discovered, mapped, and published years prior. The incident highlights how AI agents can mistake missing internal knowledge for a ground-breaking real-world discovery. It underscores the challenges of hallucination and dataset limitations in domain-specific research.

Why it matters:
Domain expertise remains essential when interpreting output from AI research agents. Ground-truth validation against authoritative external databases is required before confirming AI-generated breakthroughs.

Source: The Verge | https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/1032125/ai-agents-maya-site-...